

This is not our real website but a copy that is hopefully good enough for now.

Studierende deutschsprachiger Studiengänge, ihr findet Informationen zu eurer StEP auf der [deutschsprachigen Seite](#).

Every semester before the start of lectures, the Computer Science Students' Council organizes several introductory events for new students called StEP (short for German *student introductory phase*), which are intended to help new students in the computer science programs get started in their studies. The StEP usually takes place **the week before lectures** begin.

StEP Winter Semester 2026

- **What?** The primary introductory event for CS and related subjects, delivered to you by the CS Students' Council.
- **When?** 7th October — 9th October 2026 at 9am. Yes, that's in the week before lectures!
 - Important: Please arrive early / on time!
- **Registration?** Not necessary, just turn up on time!
- **For who?** CS & related subjects. Bachelors & Masters. German Students & Internationals. Unsure if your specific course of study is covered? Read the [FAQ](#) below!
- **Where?** E2 2. You can find a map of the campus [here](#) (check the [FAQ](#) for arrival instructions).
- **How long?** We expect to be finished in the (late) afternoon on each day. However, we still have **evening events for socialising** and cordially invite all StEP participants to attend!

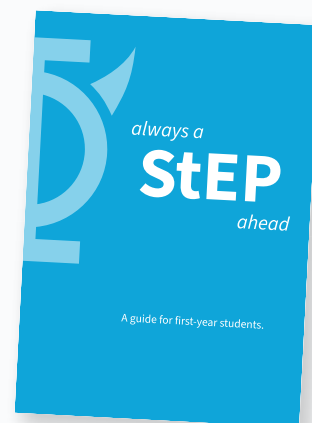
If you are travelling by **bus or train**: You have already paid for a „Deutschlandsemesterticket“ (you'll learn about that during StEP), but you must first *obtain* it in order to use public transportation. Do this several working days before the StEP so that you can use it for your journey. You can find out how this works on [the university's website](#).

Orientation Document



Our Orientation Document is the ideal companion for, during and after the StEP orientation-event! In this document, we summarize the key points of the StEP once again. But don't forget to attend StEP anyway: this document doesn't replace the much more detailed introductory presentations 😊

[Download Orientation Document](#)



Schedule for Master and International Bachelor Students

Presentations of the English StEP are tailored towards students of **Master and International Bachelor** programmes. Students of German Bachelor study programmes (regardless of their preferred tongue), please attend [German StEP](#) as regulations for your programmes differ from English ones and are only covered there.

● Events ● Studies ● Institutions ● [Internationals-only](#)

Wednesday

09:00 – 09:10 **Welcome & Kick-off**

Welcome to this semester's StEP! Here is a brief overview of the organizational details and what you can expect over the next few days.

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

09:10 – 09:30 **Students' Council (FSR)**

Hi! We are the CS Students' Representative Council. We are composed of students like you and have the task of supporting students and providing a middle ground for communication between students and the university. And – we also organize the StEP!

<https://fsr.saarland/>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

09:35 – 09:45 **Rooms**

In this presentation we will explain where you can study/work and at what times you can enter these buildings and rooms.

<https://fsr.saarland/student-rooms>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

09:45 – 10:00 **(Public) Transport and Other Joys**

What is the best way to get to the university? Can I travel throughout



Germany with my semester ticket? What about parking at the university?

We answer all these questions here!

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

10:00 – 11:00 Guest Lecture: Agentic Software Development - a Checkpoint (Prof. Dr. Jens Dittrich)

AI agents are changing software development at a remarkable pace. AI agents are the most important invention since the invention of the wheel and the use of electrical and nuclear energy.

I will give an overview of the state of the art in agent-based software development and show a live demo of agentic coding. Drawing on my own experience building and running production software with agentic development, I will then discuss what this shift means for the job market, evolving job roles, and CS and software education. This is an updated version of a talk I gave in June 2026.

<https://bigdata.uni-saarland.de/>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

11:05 – 11:20 Gastronomy

In this lecture we would like to show you how not to starve on campus and where you can top up your caffeine reserves.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/study/campus/food>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

11:20 – 12:20 Lunch Break (+ Top-up card)

 nom

<https://mensaar.de/#/menu/sb>

Mensa D4.1, or wherever you want

12:20 – 12:35 Study Coordination

The Computer Science study coordination team introduces itself and explains how you can get help there.

HS002, E1.3

12:40 – 13:50 University Systems: LSF, SIM, CMS

At school, you were given a set schedule, but at university, you can create your own. Here, we'll explain how to do that and what the CMS and LSF have to do with it.

HS002, E1.3

14:05 – 14:15 Psychologisch-Psychotherapeutische Beratungsstelle (PPB)

We will introduce you to the Psychological-Psychotherapeutic Counseling Center (German: Psychologisch-Psychotherapeutische Beratungsstelle, PPR). Here you can get free psychological counseling



... etc. Here you can get free psychological counselling.

<https://www.stw-saarland.de/en/counselling/student-counselling/>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

14:15 – 14:25 **Studierendenwerk**

The Studierendenwerk is an institution that you will come across often, whether at the Mensaar or in the context of getting a dormitory.

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

14:25 – 14:30 **Announcements**

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

14:35 – 16:00 **Institute Visits**

Are you interested in what renowned institutes such as the Max Planck Institute for Informatics (MPI-INF), the Max Planck Institute for Software Systems (MPI-SWS) or the German Research Centre for Artificial Intelligence (DFKI) get up to? Then here's your chance to take a little peek behind the scenes and have a look around one or two of their sites. Get ready for a treat!

Platz der Informatik (in front of E1.3)

16:10 – 17:10 **Campus Tour**

We'll show you where to find the most important places on your new university's campus. Unlike a school campus, ours is more akin to a "small town" and even has a few curiosities here and there. Get ready for some (un)useful facts and fun facts!

<https://map.fsr.saarland/>

Platz der Informatik (in front of E1.3)

Thursday

09:00 – 09:30 **Welcome to Saarbrücken**

Welcome to Saarbrücken! In this presentation, we will tell you everything you need to know once you arrive here - from registration at the city hall to taxes.

HS002, E1.3

09:30 – 09:45 **German Bureaucracy**

The aim of this talk is to encourage students to adopt a zen-like attitude when dealing with German bureaucracy because, in the end, it's just another part of the experience.

HS002, E1.3

09:45 – 10:15 **International Study Centre Saar (ISZ Saar)**

The International Study Centre Saar (German: Internationales Studienzentrum Saar/ISZ Saar) is a central institution at Saarland



Studienzentrum Saar, ISZ Saar, is a central institution at Saarland University that helps international applicants prepare to study at the university.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/institution/isz-saar>

HS002, E1.3

10:35 – 10:50 **Center for International Students (ZiS)**

The Center for International Students (ZiS) helps incoming international students to become acquainted with university and university life by offering a selection of leisure and recreational activities, student mentors and a broad range of information material.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/global/welcome-center/intercultural-life>

HS002, E1.3

10:50 – 11:10 **International Office (IO): Welcome Center**

The Welcome Center of the International Office is the place to reach out to when you came here from abroad. They can provide you with guidance on how to live and work here and also the preparation of your departure after you completed your studies.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/international/going/international-office>

HS002, E1.3

11:10 – 11:40 **Foreigners' Office**

The foreigners' office is responsible for issuing residence permits to international students from outside the European Union. In this presentation, Clemens explains the procedures.

In the "Foreigners' Office Q&A" you'll later have the chance to ask your question.

HS002, E1.3

11:45 – 12:00 **Student Blues**

Surviving the Student Blues: Tips and tricks for managing stress and maintaining well-being throughout your academic journey.

HS002, E1.3

12:00 – 13:00 **Lunch Break**

 om nom

<https://mensaar.de/#/menu/sb>

Mensa D4.1, or wherever you want

13:00 – 13:15 **Earning While Learning**

All you need to know about working part time, what a "HiWi job" is, Erasmus & Internships! For many of you, the question of a student job is highly relevant. We will tell you the options you have and the important things to consider while looking for a job.



Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

13:15 – 13:35 International Office (IO): Go Out! Center

Do you dream of spending a semester abroad? Or maybe a whole year? The International Office will provide you with information about partner programs, study abroad opportunities, and what you need to keep in mind! Afterward, student council members who are currently spending or have spent a semester abroad will share their experiences.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/international/out/io>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

13:40 – 13:45 Internet on Campus

How do I get on the Internet (on campus)? This essential question of life is answered here.

<https://cs.fs.uni-saarland.de/en/special/internet/>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

13:45 – 14:45 Guest Lecture: Mathematical Image Processing (PD Dr. Pascal Peter)

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/fakultaet-mi/peter.html>

Günter Hotz lecture hall, E2.2

14:55 – 15:25 How Saarland Uni Works

A practical guide to German universities especially Saarland University — because Germany and also within Germany the Saarland likes to do things differently for some reason 🤔.

HS002, E1.3

15:30 – 16:10 Study and Exam Regulations

The study regulations and the examination regulations are the two central documents for your degree programme. They regulate exactly which modules you are allowed to take and how the examinations are organised. In this lecture, we explain how it all works.

HS002, E1.3

16:15 – 16:20 Announcements

HS002, E1.3

16:30 – 17:30 Foreigners' Office Q&A

During this Q&A, Clemens will answer your questions about the Foreigners' Office.

HS002, E1.3

17:30 – 19:00 City Tour

Discover the charm of Saarbrücken: A guided tour for new students exploring the city's culture and hidden gems!

Platz der Informatik (in front of E1.3)



Friday

09:00 – 09:20 **Git, Linux, LaTeX**

At university, you will encounter all kinds of tools that are either necessary for certain lectures or can be very helpful. What they all have in common is that the learning curve can be quite steep. This makes it all the more important to start learning early! Here, we introduce you to Git, LaTeX, and Linux and explain what they are good for.

HS002, E1.3

09:20 – 09:40 **Language Center (SZSB)**

At the Language Centre, the university offers you the opportunity to take language courses free of charge (!!). We can only recommend this from our own experience!

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/institution/language-centre>

HS002, E1.3

09:45 – 10:05 **Teaching and Learning Centre (ZeLL)**

The ZeLL (Centre for Teaching and Learning) offers courses designed to help students acquire skills that go beyond the standard curriculum. In this talk, the Centre's Department of Higher Education Pedagogy will introduce itself.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/institution/zell>

HS002, E1.3

10:05 – 10:30 **Plagiarism**

You've never heard of plagiarism? Then you should definitely listen to this lecture! In addition to an explanation of the term, you will learn why plagiarism is bad and how it can end your studies.

HS002, E1.3

10:35 – 10:55 **General Student Committee (AStA)**

The General Student Committee (German: Allgemeiner Studierendenausschuss, AStA) is the central representative organ of the student body within the university. They organize events, manage the semester, provide counselling regarding work and offer support for students with problems.

<https://asta.uni-saarland.de/>

<https://stupa.uni-saarland.de/>

HS002, E1.3

10:55 – 11:10 **Examination Boards**

The examination board of a degree programme is one of the most important



bodies you will come into contact with during your studies. You can find out what tasks it fulfils and what you should know about it here.

HS002, E1.3

11:15 – 11:30 **Student Service Center (SSC)**

This presentation introduces the SSC. The SSC is the link between the individual service facilities at the university and the place where you can find initial information on all study-related topics as well as support in finding your way around campus.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/neue-seite/studies/student-service-centre>

HS002, E1.3

11:30 – 12:00 **Research Groups & Theses**

In this lecture, we will explain how to find a department to supervise your final-year dissertation and which departments and research groups are available at the SIC.

HS002, E1.3

12:00 – 13:00 **Lunch Break**

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<https://mensaar.de/#/menu/sb>

Mensa D4.1, or wherever you want

13:00 – 13:10 **Student Printer (Sakamoto)**

Printers, the machines from the underworld. We operate such a device for you. Here we explain how you can use our printer and what you should bear in mind.

<https://print.fsr.saarland/>

HS002, E1.3

13:10 – 13:20 **Equality Office**

Female members of the university and the LGBTQIA* community can seek advice, guidance and support from the Equality Office on all relevant issues relating to their professional lives or studies (funding opportunities, career planning, maternity leave, (sexual) discrimination and violence).

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/administration/gender-equality-office>

HS002, E1.3

13:25 – 13:40 **Equal Opportunities and Diversity Management Unit (CDM)**

The Office of Equal Opportunity and Diversity Management (CDM) serves as a point of contact for all members of the university regarding issues of equal opportunity, equity, and diversity management.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/administration/diversity>

HS002, E1.3



13:40 – 13:55 **Library for Computer Science and Mathematics**

In this presentation, the library director, Simone Schulze, will introduce you to the library's services and explain, among other things, what the “semester collection” is all about.

<https://www.infomath-bib.de/>

HS002, E1.3

14:00 – 15:00 **Guest Lecture: Sustainable Computing Systems or the inevitable next StEP? (Dr. Andreas Schmidt)**

In this talk, Dr. Schmidt will give a brief introduction to sustainability and in particular global warming. Afterwards, we see how large and where computing's footprint is in global emissions. Eventually, we have a look at a (literally) hot topic: Data Center's in space.

<https://depend.cs.uni-saarland.de/~schmidt/>

HS002, E1.3

15:10 – 15:30 **Fun things in and around Saarbrücken**

What are some fun places to visit in Saarbrücken and surroundings? Ideas how to spend your weekends and some secret tips to find your way around Saarland - that's what you'll find in this presentation.

HS002, E1.3

15:30 – 16:15 **Student Clubs**

Students can join various clubs. Here are a few of them. Maybe there's something for you too!

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/study/campus/recreation>

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/study/campus/get-involved>

HS002, E1.3

16:20 – 16:35 **Sports with Amir**

Here you'll learn from Amir what sports activities are available at university and in the city.

<https://www.uni-saarland.de/en/institution/sports>

HS002, E1.3

16:35 – 16:45 **Goodbye**

Let's look back at what we've learned and “learned” at StEP.

HS002, E1.3

17:00 – 17:30 **Speed Friending**

Do you know what speed dating is? Good. This is the same concept, but for people who'd like to meet new people in a relaxed setting. During short get-to-know-you sessions, you'll have the chance to make new friends and can then ‘drag’ them along to our games night to round off the evening with a game of Werewolf or something similar.



Ground floor, E1.3

17:30 – 21:30 Game Night (Board & Video Games)

After a long day of StEP, we invite you all to round off the day with a cozy games evening. We offer board games and video games, so there's something for everyone. Of course, you are also welcome to bring your own (board) games! We sell drinks and order pizza in the evening.

Ground and 1st floor, E1.3

Welcome to Saarland University

We want to tell you everything you need about your new university, its structure, the support institutions and amenities, how to get around in Saarbrücken and – if you just arrived from abroad – some quick start tips for Germany. We hope to address all of your study-related questions and help you get started as smoothly as possible.

What can I do until then?

- [Download our Orientation Documents!](#) They can be used as a handy reference before, alongside and after the StEP.
- Important: [Check if you can access your uni mail address!](#) (!! (!!!!!)) Check and double check the contents of said mailbox every day, as you will receive important uni-related information **to this mail only**.
- Obtain your [semester ticket!](#)
- For Internationals (even if you haven't arrived yet): The [International Office](#) holds a [Welcome Day](#) for international students. The presentations are hybrid, so you can attend even if you haven't arrived yet. We strongly encourage you to participate in the Welcome Day if you come from abroad. There you will be able to receive a lot of helpful information regarding your stay in Germany. You can attend (and are strongly recommended to!) both the **Welcome Day and the StEP**.
- Check out the [semester overview website](#) of the Saarland Informatics Campus.
- Note down the times of your study programme specific intro event. This event will happen on **30th of March**, the day before the StEP and is specific to your course of study. An overview over all events can be found on the [semester overview website](#).
- Join our [Discord server!](#)
- Join our [mailing list!](#)



If you currently have more questions [just write us a mail](#) or [visit our Discord](#).

FAQ

- ▶ I am not available on the days of the StEP. Are there going to be recordings?
- ▶ What is the target audience for this event?
- ▶ Should I attend all presentations?
- ▶ I have urgent questions that can't wait till the StEP, who can I ask?
- ▶ What is the difference between the StEP and the Welcome Week of the International Office?
- ▶ What is the difference between the StEP and the study course specific intro events?
- ▶ How should I get to University?
- ▶ What does StEP stand for?
- ▶ How much time should I plan for? Will there be a detailed schedule?

Upcoming Events

[Show all events & Calendar](#)

Council Meetings

The meetings are held in the **council room (E1 3, room 109)**. In case you want to propose a topic, please send us an email with a short description.

Next Meeting:

[Latest meeting minutes](#)

Contact

Do you need advice? Feel free to spontaneously drop by our **student council**





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